FIGHTERBASE

Flexitarian

Diet guide

Mostly plants, some meat and fish.



Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Flexitarian**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Flexitarian?

Mostly vegetarian, with meat or fish now and then. A popular middle way for people eating less meat for health, cost or the planet.

Where it comes from

The word joins 'flexible' and 'vegetarian' and became popular in the 2000s. It is a mostly plant-based way of eating that still leaves room for meat and fish.

The main ideas

1. Plants are the centre of most meals: vegetables, fruit, beans, lentils, wholegrains, nuts and seeds.
2. Meat and fish are included in smaller amounts and less often.
3. Choose better-quality meat and fish when you do eat them.
4. There is no strict line. A common starting point is two or three meat-free days a week and building from there.

Who it suits

- People who want to eat more plants without giving up meat
- People cutting back for health, cost or the environment
- Households with mixed diets

> **Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:**
> - You are pregnant, a child or a teenager (nutrient needs matter)
> - You have iron deficiency or anaemia

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Beans, lentils, tofu, eggs, dairy and fish carry protein on meat-free days.
- Rice, potatoes, oats, bread and pasta cover carbs around training.
- Keep a protein at every meal to protect muscle.
- Pair plant iron foods with vitamin C (peppers, citrus) to help absorption.

> Mix animal and plant proteins. Lentils and rice, eggs and dairy make easy recovery meals.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Protein
less meat means planning protein
Where: beans, lentils, tofu, eggs, dairy, fish, poultry

Iron
plant iron is absorbed less well
Where: lentils, beans, dark greens, fortified cereal, red meat now and then

Vitamin B12
found mainly in animal foods
Where: meat, fish, eggs, dairy, fortified foods

Omega-3
fish is the best source
Where: oily fish, walnuts, flax

Common mistakes

- Replacing meat with cheese and pasta only
- Forgetting protein on meat-free days
- Overusing processed meat substitutes
- Not thinking about iron

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- 'Plant-based' processed foods can be high in salt and saturated fat
- Check protein per serving on meat substitutes

Eating out

- Look for bean, lentil, tofu or egg dishes.
- Choose fish over red meat.
- Ask for extra vegetables.

Easy swaps

Beef mince	→	Half mince, half lentils
Chicken curry	→	Chickpea curry
Bacon sandwich	→	Egg and avocado sandwich
Burger	→	Bean burger or half-meat burger

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Porridge, banana, nuts	Lentil and veg soup, bread	Chickpea and spinach curry with rice
Tue	Eggs on toast	Tuna and bean salad	Chicken stir-fry with veg and noodles
Wed	Greek yoghurt, berries, oats	Hummus and falafel wrap	Veggie chilli with rice
Thu	Peanut butter on toast, fruit	Jacket potato, beans, cheese	Salmon, potatoes, greens
Fri	Omelette and toast	Chicken and avocado salad	Tofu and vegetable stir-fry
Sat	Pancakes with fruit	Minestrone	Bean and veg tacos
Sun	Smoked salmon and eggs	Leftovers bowl	Roast chicken with lots of vegetables

Snacks

Hummus and veg · Fruit and nuts · Yoghurt · Edamame · Oatcakes and peanut butter

Shopping list

Beans, lentils, chickpeas (tinned or dried) · Tofu, eggs, yoghurt, cheese · Oats, rice, pasta, wholemeal bread · Fresh and frozen vegetables, fruit · Fish and a little meat · Nuts, seeds

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

Is it a diet or a lifestyle?

Neither word matters. It is simply eating more plants most of the time.

How much meat is OK?

There is no fixed amount. Many people aim for meat once or twice a week, or in small portions.

Further reading

British Dietetic Association; NHS.



For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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